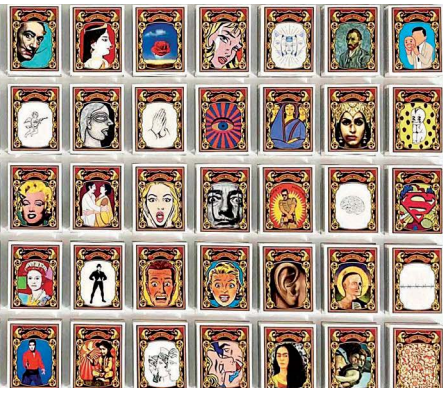








ECLECTIC MIX
(Clockwise from left) 'Searching Home 3' by Kaushik Saha (Exhibit 320), 'Somewhere in Northeast India Part-III' by Chandan Bez Baruah (Latitude 28), 'To Be Continued II' by Prajjwal Chowdhury (Latitude 28), Untitled by Atul Dodiya (Vadehra Art Gallery) and 'Miniature Costumes' by Geeta Khandelwal (Blueprint 12)

respective stables. Obviously, large-scale events, art fairs, etc. are wonderful opportunities because everybody can participate but they are also costly to put together. Smaller, contemporary art can often get overlooked in these big-tent events. Something like the DCAW is ideal for them."

Among Latitude 28's lineup for the DCAW is Chandan Bez Baruah, whose woodcuts bestow a unique and distinctive texture to everyday scenes from Northeast India (the artist hails from Guwahati). 'Somewhere in Northeast India Part-III' (Woodcut, 24x108 inches, 2023) is an ambitious work in both scale and sheer amount of detailing. The in-between texture straddling figurative art and photography that Bez Baruah achieves here is impressive. Prajjwal Chowdhury, another artist in Latitude 28's lineup, channelises the energy of Warhol-esque pop art in 'To Be Continued II' (digital print on handmade matchboxes, 48x26 inches, 2024), where you'll find iconic images of Marilyn Monroe and Salvador Dali close to Salman Khan's Chulbul Pandey character from *Dabangg*. Images of pathbreaking artists, from Dali to Van Gogh to Kahlo, are liberally sprinkled throughout the array, creating a kind of art-history-by-proxy across Chowdhury's work. "Prajjwal is also a printmaker," Kakar says. "But he doesn't limit his printmaking practice to traditional methods. In this particular work, if you see, these are digitally printed matchboxes and it's a really fresh approach. These are images from popular consciousness across many different cultures, presented in a really unique way."

DCAW has grown significantly since it began in 2017, but one of the objectives that has remained constant is to bring younger artists into the spotlight. With the likes of Chowdhury and Bez Baruah among the lineup, that mission is well-served. ■

–Aditya Mani Jha

EMORY

foreign places (she works between her hometown, Paris, and NYC). Her 'Father, Son' (diptych) depicts large hands oil-painted on Indian silk carpets; the hands are rendered in a very European technique and style (almost reminiscent of Egon Schiele's works) but put on something so obviously South Asian, almost as if to bridge the liminal gap between the two worlds. Upstairs, the striking installation 'Curtain' engages with the politics of gender identity where Dhanbad-based emerging artist Samiksha uses toilet paper bandaged around G.I. wire to create calligraphic text that draws keywords from news headlines and uses light projection to further heighten the narrative.

The exhibition is curated by TAK Contemporary, a trio of Indian-origin art professionals based in Paris. Apart from promoting artists from the Indian subcontinent and diaspora in Europe, they also focus on enhancing accessibility of international contemporary art in India. *Paysages Politisés* showcases more than 30 works by eight artists from across Asia and Europe who bring their interdisciplinary practices to explore the memory facets as an immaterial site. "We are looking at this idea of memories as a tangible site where multiple narratives converge, these metaphorical landscapes that we build for ourselves through our socio-political-economic context," says gallery founder Ayesha Parikh. Consider the otherworldly landscapes of Sujith S.N. that invite the spectator to observe a terrain beyond its physicality. To accompany this anomalousness are Harold Paule's figurative works in oil pastels on the themes of migration, displacement, and emptiness.

PAYSAGES POLITISÉS continues until Sept. 18 at Art and Charlie, Bandra, Mumbai

Also on show is 'Storm' by Spanish multi-disciplinary artist Susanna Inglada who is based in the Netherlands. Her series of large-scale charcoal-on-paper full-body figures in dynamic, contorted poses examines themes of power relations, authority, corruption, complicity and gender inequality. Contrasting against these are Mansoor's ethereal paintings depicting her memories from Pakistan—with the canvas frame wrapped in muslin cloth. "In Muslim ritual, muslin is used to wrap the deceased; it's her symbolic way of laying a memory to rest, of being at peace with it," says Parikh. ■

–Prachi Joshi